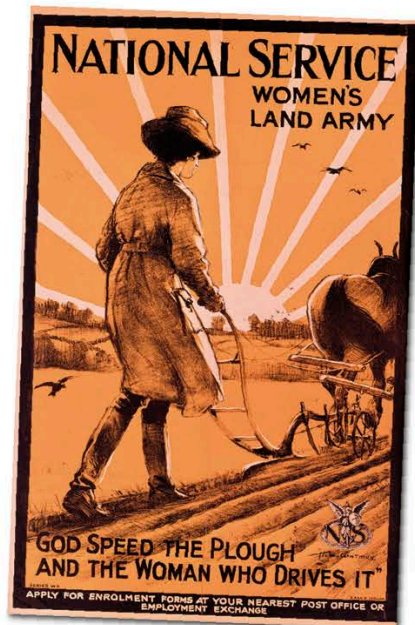




▲ WOMEN DURING THE WAR

Women played a major role in the war, many taking on jobs that had previously been denied to them because of their sex. They worked in ammunition factories, on farms producing food, and ran local businesses. On the front, many women served as nurses, ambulance drivers, and support staff to the troops.

▼ EASTERN FRONT

Unlike on the Western Front, the battle line of the Eastern Front moved back and forth as the large German, Russian, and Austrian armies fought to win territory. The Eastern Front stretched from the Baltic Sea in the north to the Black Sea in the south. Fighting continued until Russia left the war after the revolution of October 1917.



◀ HARLEM HELLFIGHTERS

When the US entered the war, hundreds of thousands of troops were shipped across the Atlantic to fight in Europe. Among them were the Harlem Hellfighters, an infantry regiment from the New York Army National Guard. This regiment was made up mainly of Black Americans, because the US Army segregated its troops by skin color.

ARMISTICE AND PEACE ▶

By 1918, Germany was struggling. The US had now entered the war, food was short, and many soldiers had deserted. On November 11, 1918, Germany and the Allies signed an armistice (an agreement to stop fighting). In Britain, many people commemorate those who died by wearing red poppies around this date each year.



MAJOR BATTLES

1914

The German advance into France is stopped in September by French and British troops at the First Battle of the Marne.

1915

The Allies attack the Ottoman Empire (a German ally) at the Gallipoli Peninsula in modern-day Turkey. The assault ends in failure.

1916

In France, the 140-day-long Battle of the Somme, between German and Allied troops, results in more than one million casualties with neither side gaining an advantage.

1917

The Third Battle of Ypres, fought between the Allies and Germany in Belgium, ends in a stalemate with massive loss of life on both sides.